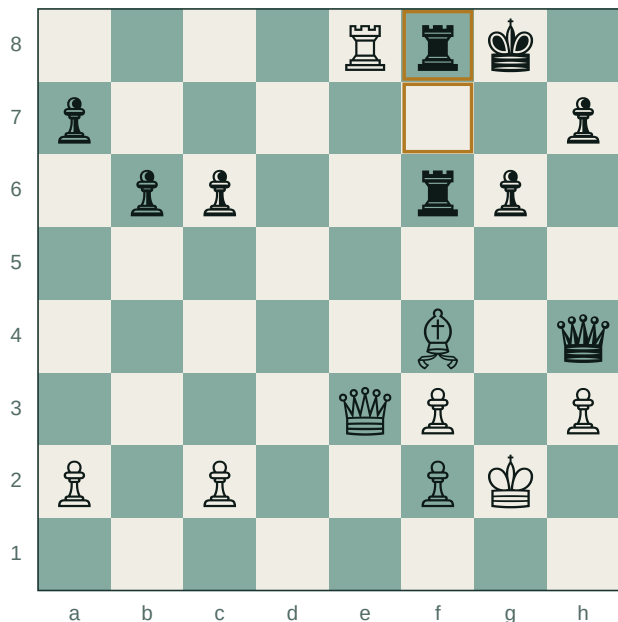


Forks and double attacks: White, move 29

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 28...Rf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. Bg5 Qxg5+ 30. Qxg5

29.Bg5 The bishop moves from f4 to g5. From g5 it attacks queen on h4 and rook on f6. Recorded reply: **29...Qxg5+**.

30.Qxg5 The queen captures the queen on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: rook on f8.